TEAM NO VOWELS

Training Targets:

1. Pronoun usage
2. RAs being able to effectively discuss the purpose of name tags with pronouns for everyone on doors (not just those who go by or have them), Bulletin board during March etc. *
3. Focus more on gender identity vs. sexuality education
4. Scenarios where people are coming out as trans/nonbinary and how to handle
5. Resources for name/pronoun changes at UMD
6. Educate RAs on how to identify potential discrimination between roommates or other community members, and give them the tools to intervene.
7. RAs offer a place for residents to drop
8. RAs giving residents info about how the housing system works and pros/cons for nonbinary individuals
9. RAs knowing and being able to give students access to transgender and nonbinary resources on campus (training on these resources for RAs) *
10. Educate RAs about the "University of Maryland Policy of Non-Discrimination on the Basis of Gender Identity or Expression in the Use of Gendered Facilities" so they are well prepared to deal with any potential incidents

Upon group discussion, we concluded that these training objectives were the most necessary, least proficient, and most feasible.

Narrowed Training Targets:

1. Training Target: Knowledge of university-offered trans/non-binary resources to distribute (Knowledge)
    a. Training Objective: From recall, Resident Assistants should be able to convey at least 1 relevant, reliable, and up to date on-campus resource to transgender and nonbinary residents that are accurate to their situation.
2. Training Target: The ability to appropriately communicate the importance of pronoun/ chosen name usage (Skill)
    a. Training Objective: When an informal or formal conversation surrounding pronoun usage or gender arises, resident assistants should be able to properly and comfortably convey messages about the importance of pronouns and the topic of gender as a social construct and spectrum for residents in a way that leaves students feeling more confident in their ability to educate their peers.

Explanation:

Based on our nonbinary resident interview, training objective 1 became relevant as our trainee interviewee explained that there was a frequent lack of explicit knowledge or availability of current resources related to transgender and nonbinary inclusion and campus opportunities. Additionally, because nonbinary and transgender inclusion training is currently optional for resident assistants, proficiency when it comes to providing resources among RAs at UMD is low. As such, a training objective focused on making sure resident assistants are well-informed about these resources will promote conversation and awareness while also existing as the simplest and most direct way to make a positive change.

Furthermore, based on our RA interview, we found that this RA's knowledge came from personal efforts rather than the optional training provided. As training objective 2 explains, by training RAs on the importance of pronouns, and the ability to facilitate a discussion surrounding gender identity and pronoun usage, they will be able to create a more inclusive resident community that allows all residents to feel comfortable and well-respected in their space. This process could be easily integrated into current RA training programs through simulated scenarios that are a regular part of RA training.